

## Focus Recovery Program

Editable-source review export. This is a working founder-review draft, not a customer file or available product.

FOUNDER REVIEW DRAFT — NOT FOR SALE

# Focus Recovery Program — Complete Draft Content v0.1

**Appropriate-use boundary:** This is a practical workflow resource. It is not clinical care, therapy, diagnosis, treatment, crisis support, burnout recovery, medical guidance, or a guarantee about focus, wellbeing, mood, or productivity. If a person needs qualified or urgent help, this is not the right resource.

## Program Introduction

### A reset is not a restart from zero

When a week becomes crowded, the first useful move is often not to work harder. It is to see what is actually active, decide what belongs today, and make one condition easier to protect. This program offers seven short working sessions. Each session has one practical mission, a worksheet or action card, one brief reflection, and a completion step.

The program does not ask you to become a different person in seven days. It asks you to create evidence for a calmer next week.

## How to use the program

1. Work with the current day only. You do not need to finish every page perfectly.
2. Write concrete nouns and actions where you can: “send the outline” is easier to use than “make progress.”
3. Make the mission smaller if it is too large. A smaller honest action is more useful than an ambitious blank page.
4. Keep your commitments practical. This workbook is not a place to make promises to other people you cannot support.
5. At the end of each day, choose one completion step that makes tomorrow easier.

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## Start Check-In

Start date: \_\_\_\_

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## One recovery outcome

At the end of seven days, I want my workflow to feel more workable because:

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## Current commitment inventory

List what is actively asking for your attention. Use short phrases. Do not solve the list yet.

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

The item that feels loudest is: \_\_\_\_\_

The item that is most meaningful is: \_\_\_\_\_

One condition that would make this week easier is: \_\_\_\_\_

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# Day 1 — Stop the Drift

## Daily lesson

A crowded workflow can make every item feel equally urgent. Today is not for resolving every obligation. It is for making the field visible enough to choose a direction. Name what is active, notice what has no next action, and select one recovery outcome for this seven-day period.

## Practical mission

Create an honest inventory of current commitments. Then circle no more than three items that still deserve active attention this week.

# Action Card: Active / unclear / parked

| COMMITMENT | WHAT IS THE NEXT VISIBLE ACTION? | ACTIVE THIS WEEK / UNCLEAR / PARKED |
|------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| _____      | _____                            | _____                               |
| _____      | _____                            | _____                               |
| _____      | _____                            | _____                               |
| _____      | _____                            | _____                               |
| _____      | _____                            | _____                               |
| _____      | _____                            | _____                               |

My seven-day recovery outcome is:

The three items I will treat as active are:

1.

2.

3.

## Small reflection

What became less noisy once I wrote it down?

# Completion step

Put one visible mark beside tomorrow's first active item: \_\_\_\_\_

## Day 2 — Clear the Field

### Daily lesson

Not every obligation needs the same response. Some deserve continued attention. Some need a date. Some need another person's help. Some need to be removed from the active field. Clearing the field is not avoidance when the choice is named and recorded.

### Practical mission

Give each active or unclear obligation one honest response: **keep, defer, delegate, or remove.**

### Action Card: Four decisions

| OBLIGATION | KEEP / DEFER /<br>DELEGATE / REMOVE | WHY THIS IS THE MOST<br>HONEST RESPONSE | NEXT COMMUNICATION<br>OR RECORD |
|------------|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| _____      | _____                               | _____                                   | _____                           |
| _____      | _____                               | _____                                   | _____                           |
| _____      | _____                               | _____                                   | _____                           |
| _____      | _____                               | _____                                   | _____                           |

One item I am deliberately deferring is: \_\_\_\_\_

The date or cue for reviewing it is: \_\_\_\_\_

One item I can ask someone else to help with, if appropriate, is:

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## Small reflection

Which decision gave me the most room without creating a new promise?

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## Completion step

Make one small update—calendar note, list change, or respectful message—so the decision exists outside your head.

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# Day 3 — Choose the Big Thing

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## Daily lesson

A priority is not a slogan. It is a specific piece of work you can recognize when it is done or moved. Today, choose one Big Thing for the next several days. Make it small enough to begin and meaningful enough to protect.

# Practical mission

Select one priority and write a definition of done, a first action, and a boundary around what it is not.

## Action Card: One priority

**My Big Thing:**

**It is done—or usefully moved—when:**

**The first action that takes less than 15 minutes is:**

**This priority is not:**

**One support task that genuinely helps is: \_\_\_\_\_**

**One tempting task that does not belong is: \_\_\_\_\_**

## Small reflection

What makes this priority worth choosing now?

## Completion step

Prepare the first action so it can begin tomorrow without a search, a decision, or a setup task.

# Day 4 — Protect the Focus Block

## Daily lesson

Focus does not require a perfect day. It requires one period that is protected enough to start. A protected block can be brief, visible, and imperfect. The important part is knowing what interruption is likely and what you will do when it arrives.

## Practical mission

Choose one realistic focus block and write an interruption plan and a fallback plan.

## Action Card: Focus-block plan

**Date:** \_\_\_ **Start time:** \_\_\_ **End time:** \_\_\_

**Big Thing action for this block:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Where I will work:** \_\_\_\_\_

**What I will place out of reach or postpone:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Likely interruption:** \_\_\_\_\_

**My interruption response:** \_\_\_\_\_



**Fallback block if this one disappears:** \_\_\_\_\_

**The smallest version that still counts:** \_\_\_\_\_

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## Small reflection

What condition is most worth protecting: time, place, tool, boundary, or first action?

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## Completion step

Place one cue for the block where you will see it: \_\_\_\_\_

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# Day 5 — Reduce Task Friction

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## Daily lesson

Friction is often a signal that the next action is hidden, the environment is cluttered, or the cue is missing. Today is not for making an elaborate system. It is for removing one small barrier between you and a useful first action.

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## Practical mission

Identify one friction point. Then change the environment, cue, or next action—not all three at once.

# Action Card: Friction reset

The task that feels harder than it needs to is:

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The friction I notice is:

- ☐ I cannot see the first action.
- ☐ I need to find a document or tool.
- ☐ The environment is distracting or cluttered.
- ☐ I have not made the decision that begins the task.
- ☐ Other: \_\_\_\_\_

I will test this small reset:

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My cue to begin is: \_\_\_\_\_

The next action, written as a verb, is: \_\_\_\_\_

I will know the reset helped if: \_\_\_\_\_

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## Small reflection

What did I remove, prepare, or name that made starting easier?

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## Completion step

Leave the reset in place for tomorrow; do not optimize it further today.

# Day 6 — Review the Rhythm

## Daily lesson

A sustainable rhythm is a small checkpoint you can repeat, not a rigid routine you have to earn. Today, choose one time of day and one question that can help you re-enter your work with less noise.

## Practical mission

Choose a morning, midday, or evening checkpoint. Keep it under five minutes and write the exact question it will ask.

## Action Card: My checkpoint

**I will use a:** - ☐ Morning checkpoint - ☐ Midday checkpoint - ☐ Evening checkpoint

**My cue is:** \_\_\_\_\_

**It will take:** \_\_\_\_\_ minutes

**Question 1 — What matters next?**

**Question 2 — What can wait, shrink, or be recorded?**

**Question 3 — What one condition would make the next block easier?**

Where I will keep this checkpoint: \_\_\_\_\_

## Small reflection

Why is this checkpoint realistic for my actual days?

## Completion step

Try the checkpoint once before tomorrow, even if it feels unfinished.

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# Day 7 — Continue with a Compass

## Daily lesson

The goal is not to make this week permanent. It is to take forward the pieces that created useful evidence. Today, review what moved, what created friction, and what one practice deserves another seven days.

## Practical mission

Build a seven-day continuation plan using only what you can honestly support.

# Action Card: Next seven days

One priority I will carry forward:

One commitment I will keep parked or deferred:

One focus condition I will protect:

My chosen checkpoint: \_\_\_\_\_

Day / cue for my next review: \_\_\_\_\_

One person or record I may update, if appropriate: \_\_\_\_\_

If the plan becomes too large, I will return to: \_\_\_\_\_

## Small reflection

What did I learn about making work more workable?

## Completion step

Write the date of the next review somewhere visible: \_\_\_\_\_

# Final Reflection

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## Evidence, not a verdict

What changed in the active commitment field?

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What priority did I protect or clarify?

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What focus condition helped?

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What friction do I want to design around next time?

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One practice I will continue for seven days is:

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One practice I will leave behind is:

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# Fictional Worked Example — Sam's handoff reset

Fictional workflow example. It does not describe a real person and is not clinical, medical, employment, legal, financial, or professional advice.

Sam supports a small creative team and has accumulated requests across chat, a shared board, and personal notes. Sam's seven-day outcome is not "catch up on everything." It is: **Create one clear active-request list, choose the next brief to move, and establish a five-minute end-of-day handoff note.**

On Day 1, Sam lists eight active requests. Three are genuinely active; two are waiting on someone else; three can be parked. On Day 2, Sam delegates one request by writing a clear handoff message and adds a review date to two parked items. On Day 3, the Big Thing becomes "draft the first section of the partner brief." The definition of done is "a one-page outline exists in the shared folder."

For the focus block, Sam chooses 9:30–10:00 on Thursday and puts chat notifications aside. The fallback is 3:30–3:50 if a meeting shifts. On Day 5, Sam notices that finding the correct past notes creates friction, so the reset is a single pinned link to the current shared folder. The weekly checkpoint is an evening question: "What is the next visible handoff?"

At the final reflection, Sam keeps the end-of-day handoff note, continues one 30-minute focus block, and leaves the idea of reorganizing every old note for a later, explicitly bounded project.

# Production and Accessibility Notes

- [ ] The introduction, each day, final reflection, and worked example have descriptive headings.
- [ ] All writing areas retain persistent labels; placeholder text never carries the only meaning.
- [ ] Future form controls follow visible reading order and have programmatic labels.
- [ ] Deep navy text on off-white / white paper is used for primary content; warm gold is never the only instruction signal.
- [ ] Each day's action card begins on a new print page in US Letter and A4 review layouts.
- [ ] A final accessible PDF/AcroForm, tagged-PDF review, printer proof, and assistive-technology test remain future release blockers.